POV: 1hr30min Business Talk Inside A Private Men's Members Club

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📋 Executive Summary

Chris (ONM founder) and members hold an unfiltered private conversation covering self-reliance, long-term reinvestment, the real cost of building ONM, grit vs. inherited wealth, reverse-engineering genuine success stories, and why slow compounding beats every shortcut.

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🎣 The 60% Rule: Do It Yourself First 0:00

- Core principle: get a business or skill to **60% yourself**, then bring in experts for the remaining 40%
  - Analogy: hiring a personal trainer on day one of the gym is wasteful — lift the 5 kg dumbbells yourself, get reasonably fit, *then* bring in the trainer to dial in diet and programming
  - Reaching your personal limit is a feature, not a failure — it tells you exactly where expert help is needed
- "Done-for-you" systems are the worst possible model
  - Biblical parallel: "Give a man a fish, feed him for a day; teach a man to fish, feed him for a lifetime"

- If a guru takes you from £4k/month to £10k/month but you don't understand how, when the economy shifts (AI, COVID, algorithm change) you have zero ability to adapt
- You need "40% understanding of why it went that way and how to modify it"

- Factory analogy: if a colleague drives you to work every day and then quits, you're stranded — learn to drive; at minimum get a licence so you can figure out transport yourself
- Rule stated plainly: *"Never rely on anybody for anything"*

💸 Reinvest Everything — There Is No Profit 13:28

- Chris's framing: **there is no such thing as profit** in a growing business
  - Shareholders want share value to rise; employees want their pay cheque — the space between those two things is just cash recycled back into growth
  - "Even this year if we're up by a million, I'll go — let's grow again. Let's do London. Let's do New York."
- Personal bank account is kept intentionally minimal: **£5–10k** at any given time
  - Owns Dior shoes, 3–4 jackets worth ~£3k total, one watch, a BMW X1 in Spain — describes this as "top tier" for his needs
  - Does not own a second car; takes Ubers when back in Spain
- Business-as-baby metaphor
  - Raise a child for 18 years, putting money in until they are self-sustaining — business is identical
  - After ~18 years the business pays *you* for the rest of your life
  - Most people quit before year 5 because they want to buy a Lamborghini and "stunt" to sell courses, then get trapped maintaining appearances
- Borrowing-against-equity end game
  - Once the business is large enough, go to a bank, take a line of credit (£5–10m), pay zero tax on debt, retire — "money is not real"
  - Elon Musk parallel: doesn't own a house, drives (or is driven in) a Tesla, everything is on paper

🏠 ONM's Origin, Cost, and Barrier to Replication 10:49

- When asked on YouTube "how much does a members club like ONM cost to start?", Chris itemised everything honestly — total came to **~£98,000** startup cost
  - Commenter replied "didn't realise it was that much, guess I won't bother" — Chris's reaction: "Good. Fuck off."
- Specific costs cited: ~£10k on Cannes, ~£9.2k on Finland, plus pool heater (6-month installation), Dwart's cost, flights, running costs
- Hardest barrier is **not money** — it is having the community/audience first
  - Requires ~**165,000 YouTube subscribers** and roughly **10 years of content**
  - Age/credibility matters: "If a 21-year-old said I'm going to do this, you'd be like — can I trust this?"

- Total investment in the business has now gone **well over £1 million**
  - First two years: spending more than earning; Chris is personally **down ~£250k** on a net basis across those years
  - Current model (recurring memberships) is now generating substantial income, but all of it goes back in
- The more ONM invests, the less every potential competitor is investing — a compounding moat
- Personal context mentioned: mother had cancer, father died ~2 years before filming — "I just don't think we're replicable"

🔄 The Perpetual Reinvestment Wheel vs. Fear-Based Cutting 12:43

- Common failure pattern in companies:
  - Revenue dips → cut spending → revenue dips further → cut more → spiral to bust
  - "Every company does it"
- Attacker's advantage counter-strategy:
  - Revenue dips → keep investing, find a way to do it smartly
  - Revenue dips again → put more in, bank on yourself
  - Outcome: break even, then recover, then all competitors have died out
- WeWork / Regus case study
  - Regus (described as the biggest commercial office space owner in the world) called an emergency meeting when WeWork was valued at ~£18–80 billion vs. Regus at ~£2 billion
  - Brought in finance experts, combed through the numbers — conclusion: **"Nothing. We're doing nothing wrong. WeWork's valuation is just hype."**
  - Decision: ignore them, stay patient, stick to what we know
  - Outcome implied: WeWork collapsed; Regus survived
- Principle: *"Everything is revealed long-term. There are a lot of hype merchants everywhere. Just stay patient."

🤝 Community Over Transactions: Loyalty Pays Long 19:13

- Story 1 — the non-paying member
  - A member did a small payment then stopped paying; Chris let him stay in the group and attend meals
  - Reason: he was funny, good for the community energy, no problems caused
  - Outcome: member "came into money recently" and signed up for the full yearly membership and went straight on a trip
- Story 2 — the heart condition member
  - Member was about to buy a lifetime membership (at the time **£15k**) when he received a serious heart diagnosis; told he couldn't fly for ~2 years
  - Chris's immediate response: "Fuck ONM. Who cares? Health first. I hope you're okay."

  - Gave him the **ONM Work Course for free** so he had something productive at home
  - Logic: in 2–3 years when cleared to fly, he will join; and might bring a friend — "you don't do it because of that, you do it for the right reasons"
- General philosophy on early-stage business:
  - Give free work to clients in year one; ask only for a testimonial in return
  - "The first year of your business you should pretty much be doing all free work"
  - Chris still washes up cups, takes bins out, nets the pool, puffs up cushions at the Granada house — "people are too proud to do that"
- Reputation defence: members publicly counter "scammer" accusations by citing specific acts — e.g. Chris paid £600 on the spot for a speed boat in Budva, paid for the yacht two years running
- Formula stated: *"Give 90% value early. 10% comes back. Over time it evens out and compounds your way."

🧭 What Got Chris Through the Slog 23:01

- Phase 1 — London 9-to-5 era (age 24–25)
  - Had a good girlfriend, steady job, decent life — so the downside scenario wasn't catastrophic
  - "If this doesn't work out, the alternative is normal life. It's not that bad."
  - Antidote to doom-scrolling others' success: someone without a job is looking at you with your beautiful girlfriend going "I wish I was at that guy's level"
- Phase 2 — building ONM when everyone said "just sell a course"
  - Constant pressure from audience and peers: "Sell a product. Sell a course. Sell out."
  - Internal conviction: "I just know in 10 years time I'll be the last one left."
- Prediction track record as validation
  - ~3 years before filming, named ~9–10 public figures in the men's lifestyle/online business space and predicted their downfall
  - **8 for 9** correct at time of filming (Tate in legal trouble, Belmar "finished", Wes Watson in prison, Hamza's brand nearly collapsed over testosterone disclosure, Demonetised in prison for separate issue)
  - One remaining prediction (major lawsuit against Iman Gadzhi) had not yet materialised but Chris remained "very confident"
- Core belief engine: *"If you're a good person, doing the right things, reinvesting your money with good intentions and a good team — how do you not win? It doesn't make sense."

🐟 The Fishing Analogy: Bait Your Swim and Stay Patient 34:47

- Fishing lesson from his father: resist moving pegs when you see fish splash elsewhere
  - Every fisherman's temptation: "all the fish are over there" → pack up, move → splashes appear back where you were

    - Reality: fish move randomly around the lake AND are attracted to the area you were feeding — if you leave, they finally arrive at your baited spot after you've gone
- Business translation:
    - Keep feeding the same area (content, community, reinvestment) consistently
    - The world eventually comes to you — Drake example: stayed in Toronto when everyone said be in Miami or LA; Toronto briefly became "the capital of the world" for music because he stayed
    - *"If you're good enough, the world comes to you."
- Resisting shiny objects:
    - Even today Chris feels the pull (e.g. AI animation videos getting 14m views, cheap code film-making)
    - Response: post the Ancelotti meme internally and move on (see next section)
- Deciding when to exit something
    - Synthetic crypto example: held for 5 years; exited when interview revealed the founder (nicknamed "Cocaine") had cashed out £12m at the bull market peak and clearly no longer cared; Hyperliquid had arrived as a proper competitor
    - Rule: *"When everything indicates logically it's time to go, it's obvious. You just have to be honest with yourself."

⚖️ Staying Emotionally Flat: The Ancelotti Rule 37:09

- Reference: Carlo Ancelotti (Real Madrid manager) equalises vs. Man City with ~10 minutes left; young players jump off the bench screaming; Ancelotti turns around and says calmly *"Calm down. Calm, calm, calm. Relax. We can still lose."
- Chris, James, and Charlie had a group chat rule: any time someone got overexcited about a good month or milestone, one of them would post the Ancelotti meme
    - Applied every single time — eventually Chris would pre-empt it: "I know the Ancelotti meme is coming"
- Principle: *"You can't get too high on the highs or too low on the lows. Take the emotion out of it."
- Corollary: know when to pull the plug — when something is damaging mental health or everyone around you, that's the signal; "you can put up with a bit" but there is a threshold

📋 The Five Things on Repeat for Five Years 29:07

- Chris showed his phone: a note with the same five priorities, unchanged for five years
    - ONM trips
    - Create content
    - Gym and health
    - Girlfriend / relationship
    - Investment in ONM
- Secondary filter — does the activity serve:
    - Family and relationship

    - Personal happiness, health, and fitness
    - Membership improvement / growth
    - Life setup expansion
- Anything outside these criteria gets **outsourced**
- Connection to *The One Thing* by Gary Keller: what is the single thing you can do right now that moves the needle? Do that one thing every day for 5 years and become the best in the world at it
- Chris's distilled "one thing": *"How do I make the members happy? How do I make sure men have great life setup through ONM?"* — everything else flows from that
- Simplification of ONM to three actions:
    - Stay healthy and hit the gym year-round
    - Reinvest membership money smartly into maintaining/improving the service
    - Produce content and marketing to bring in new members

🏆 Grit, Artificial Grit, and Rich-Kid Advantage 1:08:51

- Book reference: *Grit* by **Angela Duckworth**
    - Study: college students given a "grit test" (how long do you stick to things before giving up?) — tracked 20+ years later
    - Result: grit score was an **exact predictor** of life success
    - Conclusion: grit is the single biggest determining factor
- If you don't quit, you eventually win — "58 possible outcomes, 57 are failure; visit all 57 and you land on 58"
- **Artificial grit** — the rich-kid structural advantage
    - Dad gives £10m → first business fails → try again, again, again → one sticks → labelled a "genius"
    - They're not gritty; they just have an **endless pit to throw ideas at** — artificially simulating the resilience that broke people have to generate through genuine suffering
    - Very easy to maintain enthusiasm when you have £9m left in the bank after the first failure
- Poor person's grit has a **5-year rebuild window** between failures
    - Winston Churchill quote often cited: "Success is walking from one failure to another with no loss of enthusiasm" — true, but *"for poor people there's a 5-year window of rebuilding in between that they don't tell you about"*
    - Rich kids also "fail faster" because they can hire the best people from day one and learn quicker
- Warning: don't take advice from mega-successful people who are 20+ years from their grind
    - They forget what it actually took — José Mourinho example: doesn't understand modern dressing rooms because he didn't grow up with social media
    - Chris catches himself doing it: "How'd you become successful?" — has to reverse-engineer all the way back to "I worked a 9-to-5 job" to give a 17-year-old genuinely actionable advice

🔍 Reverse-Engineering Real Success (Felix Dennis, Dana White, Fertittas, Ferrari) 1:12:46

- Rule: **trace success back to its original source** — strip away inherited money and lucky relationships to find the person who actually built from scratch
- **Grant Cardone** example: tells people "buy 45 condos" → turns out he was borrowing other people's money in a structure Chris calls effectively a Ponzi
- **Pashra Shirani** (owner of Seabird restaurant London, Hawksmoor Hotel, Estelle, Masons members club)
  - Featured in GQ, Architectural Digest as a "hospitality entrepreneur genius"
  - Reality: married a billionaire's daughter in India who gave him **£1.065 billion** to invest
  - *"The only genius thing he did was marry well"* — trace back further and you find the Indian industrialist (steel empire, negotiated deals on the ground in Kazakhstan) who is the actual legitimate builder
  - That industrialist's advice — the real lesson: *"Pick the one thing that is in front of you right now. Do it 100%. Nothing else matters. Blinkers on. Once done, move to the next. Don't think about the timeline."*
- **Felix Dennis** — *How to Get Rich* (book recommendation, described as "the best book I've ever read on success")
  - Worth **£600 million**, built from scratch, owned Maxim Magazine and many others
  - Famous line: *"If it flies, floats, or fornicates, rent it."*
  - Covers everything start to finish: staff (pay them well, don't lose them), family/friends (you'll sacrifice time with them — accept it), every scenario in detail
  - "The only book where I thought — fair enough. He's done it."
- **Dana White / UFC** — reverse-engineering reveals:
  - Dana White was doing boxing coaching in Boston
  - Got the UFC off the ground with a **£2m investment** from childhood friends — the **Fertitta brothers**
  - Company was **£40m in debt** at acquisition — Fertittas funded all of it
  - Fertittas are only rich because their **father made ~£365m** from a Las Vegas hotel/casino deal
  - Conclusion: Dana White is worth £600–700m today because he knew two guys from Boston whose dad did the real work
  - *"Dana White is not the person you should be learning from. Find the Fertitta dad."*
- **Enzo Ferrari** parallel
  - Enzo was **75 years old** before he became really rich (~£50m)
  - His son now owns ~5% of Ferrari and is worth **£8–9 billion**, having "never worked a day in his life"
  - Insight: Enzo had the more interesting life — working on his passion every day, watching it evolve
  - Being handed completion robs you of the experience: "It's like somebody doing your word search in your newspaper — you'd be like, fuck you man, I wanted to do that"
- **Bugsy Siegel / Las Vegas** — built the Flamingo Hotel borrowing from the mafia; opening night was a disaster (storm, no-show, power cut, massive losses); mafia killed him; model was adopted by others; billions now flow from what he started

- *"The first guy through the door very rarely is the one that wins."*
- Self-aware note: "I'm 34, maybe my sons and daughters are the ones who have a good life — but what am I supposed to do, roll over?"

- Survivorship bias warning: motivational content online only shows the winners; the losers are invisible; therefore the advice seems to work universally but doesn't

🌍 Trip Highlights and Community Memories 49:27

- Member has been on **9 trips** at time of filming
- Trip chronology discussed:
  - **Budapest (Nov/Dec)** — first proper trip; described as the most "boys trip" feeling; ~400 eggs in a bin bag piling up, stacked dishes, Tibo screaming randomly every 2 minutes; "okay this is fun"
  - **Bali trip 1** — turning point for the brand
    - Chris had been called a scammer for 2 years; opening the villa door was a moment of genuine relief — *"Please please please"* → house was identical to photos
    - "Is business going to work? Is business going to work? We've got it."
    - Activities: jet skis, private chef dinner, shooting range (guns), meal at the house; described as "one of the best days of my life"
    - Jesse moved to Bali afterwards; Alvaro still talks about it; Nick cancelled his flight to Granada to stay — "he's like a son to me"
    - Cole came back for Bali part 2
    - Housekeeper Dharma became "the group's mum"; by day 4 she told Chris his videos were appearing on her phone via algorithm — "just by being in proximity with me"
  - **Porto** — described as the moment Chris realised "I could live like this forever"
    - Sat with James and Charlie, looked around and thought: *"Why am I living in London alone? I could be here saving £7k/month."*
    - "This is the future of the brand. This is huge."
  - **Crete** — paddle court, pool, compound feel, exceptional bedrooms (high count); Turkish bath
  - **Cannes** — described as the best house to date, makes Porto "look like a 1 out of 10"
    - Drove up through gates that opened "like a Disney princess" moment
    - Multi-layered property: base → pool → terrace → second terrace → floors 1–4 → balconies → spikes → back gardens
    - Emotional reaction for someone who grew up in poverty: *"There's no way somebody lives here. Me and my mum chose between water and milk for cereal."*
    - Elon Musk had stayed at the same house a few months prior; Tyga (rapper) also visited
    - Paparazzi drone appeared overhead — group assumed it was looking for Musk or Tyga; "It's just a bunch of degenerates from YouTube"
- Community culture observations:
  - Members are "super normal, super sound, similar-minded" — ambitious but not show-off

- New members arrive professional and stiff; within hours are posting memes and joking — that authenticity is why the group stays active
- Group chat nearly went quiet ~1–2 months after launch; Chris booked Budapest on impulse despite receiving a massive tax bill — "advantage bro, let's go" — that re-ignited everything
- Mentor in Budva: 60-year-old owner of £28m houses in Copenhagen; warned that traditional masterminds die in 3–4 years (same locations, same people, same discussions); concluded ONM's lifestyle/rental model is what differentiates it — *"That's genius. That'll work."

🎬 Life as a Simulation: The Hero's Journey 1:28:00

- Thought experiment: if you could choose your reality before entering a simulation, what would you pick?
  - Not omniscience; not being born rich
  - You'd choose: **tough upbringing → grinding → periodic improvement → massive success → family chapter with beautiful kids and dogs**
  - *"That's probably the best existence — every decade your life gets slightly better."*
- Matrix reference: Cipher choosing to go back into the Matrix for an easy, pleasure-filled fake life — Chris argues most people, if honest, would choose the difficult path for the meaning it creates
- Film recommendation: *Gold* with Matthew McConaughey (based on the Bre-X/Washoe Mining Company story)
  - Protagonist always wanted to be rich; long-term partner by his side the whole time; achieves massive success; loses himself chasing models; loses the woman; eventually realises she was what he wanted; ends with balance
  - "That's what life is — starts rough, journey of discovery, realise what you really want, become a better person, raise the next generation"
- Nvidia CEO on Joe Rogan:
  - Asked "when did it start to feel comfortable?" — answer: **"Never."**
  - Every month: make £1m, bills are £1m; make £5m, bills are £5m; perpetual payroll anxiety for **25 years**
  - Asked "would you do it again?" — *"No. Worst journey of my life. Worst mistake I ever made."* — and he runs the most valued company in the world
  - Takeaway: be careful what you wish for
- Brooklyn/Romeo Beckham cited as examples of rich kids without purpose — "lost, potentially suicidal, don't know what to do"

💰 Wealth at the Extreme: Elon Musk and the Price of a Trillion 1:34:21

- Musk's defining bet: had **£137 million** in the bank, put it all back in, took massive additional loans from investors; if the SpaceX rocket had failed, he would have gone completely bust
  - When asked "was there ever a doubt?": *"If you play, you play to win."*
  - Chris: "I've done it on a tiny scale — I get it. I don't know if I'd put 137 million back in."

- Why he's the first trillionaire: took a **risk bigger than anyone in history had before** — £137m reinvested plus ~£200m in loans
  - "That's how you get to a trillion. Nobody else is willing to do it because as soon as they get a safety net they go — that'll do."
- Downsides of extreme wealth discussed:
  - Women reportedly pitching Musk in letters asking to carry his children (no money, just genetics)
  - Every person around you is potentially extracting — cannot trust genuine friendship
  - If he upsets major shareholders, his life could be in danger — "that's the level he's at"
  - *"I don't know if people want that. I don't know if they're built for that."
- Assessment: Musk in any other era would be a king or conqueror — "Genghis Khan level mentality"
- Group jokingly notes Chris slept in the same bed Musk had occupied at the Cannes house a few months earlier — "that's when everything took off"
- Final framing: the people who *think* they want to be the richest person alive probably don't — that life looks like "hell on earth"